

Malaysia: State flags

The flags of the Malaysian states were mostly derived from those of the 19th century, and were originally flags of the princes or sultans.



JOHORE

The blue field represents the government. The red canton is for the “*Hulubalang*” warrior caste, who defend the state. The crescent and star represent the ruler.



KEDAH

Red is the traditional color of Kedah. The sheaves of yellow padi, or rice, are for prosperity. The green crescent signifies Islam and the yellow shield is for sovereignty.



KELANTAN

The red field is symbolic of the loyalty and sincerity of the people, while the white emblem represents the ruler. Kelantan has 36 royal and official flags.



KUALA LUMPUR

Blue is for the unity of the population of Kuala Lumpur; red for courage and vigor; white is for purity, cleanliness and beauty; yellow for sovereignty and prosperity.



LABUAN

The colors are those of the national flag and they have the same symbolism; white recalls the purity of Buddhism and red represents the life-blood of the people.



MELAKA

The colors and pattern are taken from the national flag. Unlike the Malaysian flag, the flag of Melaka only has one stripe of red and one of white and a five-pointed star.



NEGERI SEMBILAN

This flag reflects the hierarchy of power in Malaysia. The yellow field symbolizes the ruler, the black triangle, the district rulers and the red triangle, the people.



PAHANG

White is for the ruler, because it can change to any other color, reflecting how a ruler can be influenced by popular opinion. Black represents the people, standing firm.